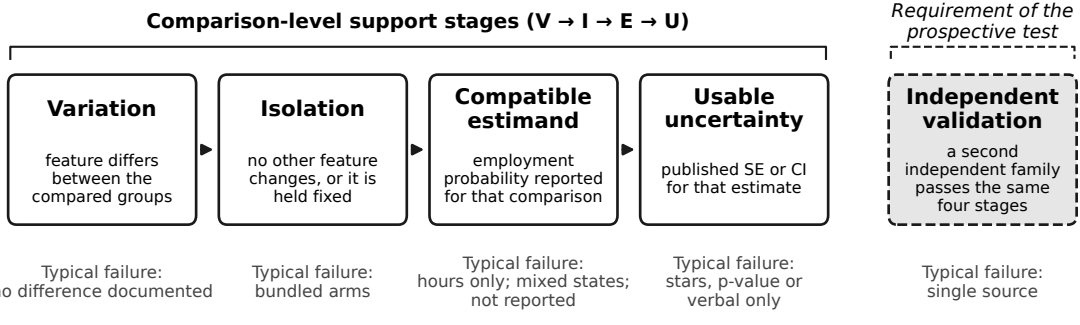

The four stages are evaluated on one comparison at a time. Independent validation is not a fifth stage: it is a requirement of this prospective test (one family for discovery, one for validation). Operational audit criteria, not a new causal theory.